

Wednesday, 16 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 19° 14°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 18° 13°	MANCHESTER Light rain 16° 13°	GLASGOW Drizzle 16° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Urgent plans are being developed for live-streaming cameras in baby cots, after an inquiry found Lucy Letby's crimes could have been prevented.

The report into the former nurse's actions highlighted systemic failings. The move to 'cot cams' aims to increase transparency and prevent future tragedies in neonatal units.

HEALTH · UK
- 2

The state pension is likely to top £13,000 a year, as UK wage growth slows to 3.9%, sparking renewed debate about its long-term affordability.

This potential increase has reignited discussions about how the state pension is funded and whether it's fair across different generations. It's a significant financial talking point for many.

ECONOMY · UK
- 3

The number of people claiming a key disability benefit has hit a record high, with the system under review and deemed 'not fit for purpose'.

The Personal Independence Payments (PIP) system is currently being assessed, following concerns about its effectiveness and fairness. This record high figure highlights the ongoing challenges.

SOCIAL CARE · UK
- 4

AI poses huge risks to national security without proper guardrails, a minister has warned, addressing growing concerns over artificial intelligence safety.

First Secretary of State Louise Haigh spoke at the TUC Congress about the critical need for regulations. The rapid advancement of AI technology brings both opportunities and significant security challenges.

TECHNOLOGY · UK
- 5

Political donors could face tougher residency rules, following large donations to Reform from British crypto-billionaires who recently lived abroad.

The current rules are under scrutiny after substantial funds were received from individuals with recent overseas residences. This could lead to significant changes in how political donations are regulated.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Oasis have confirmed more huge gigs for their reunion tour in 2027, including a return to Knebworth, plus dates in Manchester and Glasgow!**

After weeks of teasers, the band has announced a second wave of shows, sending fans into a frenzy. It's a massive comeback for the iconic Britpop group.

ON AIR – Are you excited for Oasis to be back? Which city are you hoping to get tickets for?

MUSIC · 2027

2 **Welsh actor Matthew Rhys has made Emmy Awards history, becoming the first person to win two lead acting prizes in one night!**

His double win at the prestigious TV ceremony in Los Angeles was a significant moment. Rhys was recognised for his outstanding performances in two different productions.

ON AIR – What a night for Matthew Rhys! Have you seen the shows he won for?

AWARDS · YESTERDAY

3 **Coventry's market has been transformed into a CBeebies TV set, for a new show helping young children explore food through their senses.**

The programme, filmed locally, aims to engage pre-schoolers with different foods in an interactive way. It's a fantastic initiative to get kids thinking about healthy eating.

ON AIR – A CBeebies show in Coventry market! What a fun way to get kids interested in food, don't you think?

TV · COMING UP

4 **The TV show 'The Pitt' is up for 25 Emmys, and its biggest fans are real-life doctors, who say it's the most realistic medical drama yet.**

The HBO Max show, set in a US hospital emergency room, has clearly resonated with those in the medical profession. Its accuracy is a huge talking point.

ON AIR – If real doctors are praising 'The Pitt' for its realism, does that make you want to watch it more?

TV · YESTERDAY

5 **'70 Up' is the final instalment in the groundbreaking documentary series, which has followed the lives of 14 people for six decades.**

The series began in 1964, offering a unique longitudinal study of British society. This final chapter will be a poignant farewell to the much-loved participants.

ON AIR – Have you followed the 'Up' series over the years? What do you think is the most remarkable thing about it?

TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 Referees' chief Howard Webb has admitted VAR didn't even consider if Enzo Fernandez was offside for Erling Haaland's controversial winner.

The goal in Sunday's Manchester derby sparked huge debate, and this admission only adds to the controversy. It raises more questions about the consistency of VAR decisions.

ON AIR – This VAR admission is a big talking point! Do you think it undermines confidence in the system?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 Leeds United have climbed to third in the Premier League after inflicting a heavy 4-1 defeat on Newcastle at Elland Road.

Dominic Calvert-Lewin was a standout performer for Leeds, who put in a superb display. This result is a major statement from Daniel Farke's side.

ON AIR – Leeds are flying high in the Premier League! Do you think they can keep this form going?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 London has lost its bid to host the 2029 World Athletics Championships, with Nairobi in Kenya named as the host city.

The decision means the prestigious event will head to Africa for the first time. Munich will host the 2031 championships, highlighting a shift in global sporting venues.

ON AIR – London missing out on the World Athletics Championships – are you surprised by this decision?

ATHLETICS · UK

4 Spurs' Richarlison has posted a crying emoji after being left out of the squad for Tuesday's Carabao Cup tie against Liverpool.

The forward publicly expressed his displeasure at Roberto de Zerbi's decision. It's a clear sign of frustration from the player, sparking debate among fans.

ON AIR – Richarlison's reaction is very public! Do you think players should express their feelings like this on social media?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 Former England winger Raheem Sterling has admitted dangerous driving on the motorway before crashing his Lamborghini in May.

The incident involved his car colliding with motorway barriers earlier this year. This admission brings further details to light regarding the high-profile crash.

ON AIR – Raheem Sterling admitting dangerous driving is big news. What are your thoughts on this?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing the charm of handwritten letters for everyday communication.**
Instead of emails or texts, many are finding joy in sending thoughtful, personal notes through the post, reconnecting with a more deliberate form of communication.
- 2 The delightful sound of 'rain on a conservatory roof' is being hailed as a top stress-reducer.**
Many Britons report finding this gentle, rhythmic patter incredibly soothing, making it a surprising favourite for relaxation and focus during a downpour.
- 3 More people are discovering the simple pleasure of 'observing local wildlife' in their gardens and parks.**
From watching busy squirrels to identifying garden birds, this quiet pastime offers a peaceful connection to nature and a moment of daily calm.
- 4 The quirky hobby of 'collecting interesting vintage teacups' is charming its way into British homes.**
It's all about the thrill of the hunt at antique shops and car boot sales, finding unique designs to enjoy a perfectly brewed cuppa.
- 5 A growing number of individuals are finding joy in 're-reading beloved childhood books'.**
It's a nostalgic trip down memory lane, offering comfort and a simple escape from the hustle and bustle of modern life.
- 6 The charming habit of 'leaving anonymous positive notes' in public places is spreading smiles nationwide.**
Small messages of encouragement or cheer are appearing on park benches, library books, and coffee shop windows, brightening strangers' days.
- 7 Many are rediscovering the satisfaction of 'repairing household items' rather than replacing them.**
Whether it's mending a favourite jumper or fixing a wobbly chair, there's a real sense of accomplishment in giving beloved items a new lease of life.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE PACKET INTENTLY BEFORE OPENING IT, HOPING TO GET A HINT OF THEIR DELICIOUSNESS.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new television programme, especially if it's a big series launch. What is it?

ANSWER: ENSURING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA ARE PERFECTLY PLUMPED AND ALIGNED, EVEN IF THEY'LL BE IMMEDIATELY DISARRANGED.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' from your home can just instantly make you feel relaxed and cosy, even if it's just the washing machine humming or the kettle boiling?
What's that one ordinary sound in your home that brings you the most comfort and makes you feel truly settled?

- We all have that 'one particular type of sweet or chocolate bar' that, no matter how old we get, can still instantly transport us back to our childhood or a happy memory, don't we?
What's that nostalgic treat for you, and what happy memory does it bring bubbling to the surface?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a 'space junk' problem, with over 100 million pieces of debris, ranging from tiny paint flecks to spent rocket stages, orbiting Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can see the Great Wall of China with the naked eye from orbit, making it a prominent landmark from space.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The official name for the hashtag symbol (#) is an octothorpe.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to sense sugars and other chemicals.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896.
- The human eye can distinguish approximately 10 million different colours.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's oldest known piece of chewing gum is over 9,000 years old, found in Finland.
- Honeycomb is an incredibly efficient structure; the hexagonal shape uses the least amount of wax to store the most honey.
- The 'king' in a deck of playing cards is the only one without a moustache, except for the King of Hearts.

On this day

Day 259 of the year, 106 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Andrew Kim Taegon; Christian feast day: Curcodomus; Christian feast day: Cyprian (Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Edith of Wilton. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Joel Heyman, American actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Sonny LeMaire, American country music singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1948 — Susan Ruttan, American actress
- 1976 — Tina Barrett, English singer-songwriter, dancer, and actress
- 1968 — Marc Anthony, American singer-songwriter, actor, and producer
- 1944 — Linda Kaye Henning, American actress
- 1985 — Max Minghella, English actor
- 1992 — Chase Stokes, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — Eight people escape from East Germany to the west in a homemade hot air balloon.
- 1979 — The Sugarhill Gang released their first single, Rapper's Delight.
- 2015 — A 8.3 Mw earthquake strikes the Chilean city of Illapel, killing 15 people, injuring at least 34, leaving at least six missing, and causing extensive damage. One person also dies in Argentina.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2004 — Hurricane Ivan makes landfall in Gulf Shores, Alabama as a Category 3 hurricane.
- 1975 — Cape Verde, Mozambique, and São Tomé and Príncipe join the United Nations.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2014 — The Islamic State of Iraq and the Levant launches its Kobani offensive against Syrian–Kurdish forces.
- 1979 — The Sugarhill Gang released their first single, Rapper's Delight.
- 1975 — The first prototype of the Mikoyan MiG-31 interceptor makes its maiden flight.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 260 of the year, 105 days left in 2026. Today Australian Citizenship Day; Christian feast day: Albert of Vercelli; Christian feast day: Ariadne of Phrygia; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecilia Eusepi. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Shelby Flint, American singer-songwriter and voice actress
- 1974 — Nona Gaye, American singer, model, and actress
- 1985 — Brendan Clarke, Irish footballer
- 1965 — Bryan Singer, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1946 — Billy Bonds, English footballer and manager (died 2025)
- 1986 — Sophie, English music producer, disc jockey and singer (died 2021)
- 1962 — Paul Feig, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1989 — Danielle Brooks, American actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1949 — The Canadian steamship SS Noronic burns in Toronto Harbour with the loss of over 118 lives.
- 1991 — Estonia, North Korea, South Korea, Latvia, Lithuania, the Marshall Islands and Micronesia join the United Nations.
- 2025 — Saudi Arabia and Pakistan sign the Strategic Mutual Defence Agreement.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1965 — The Battle of Chawinda is fought between Pakistan and India.
- 1948 — The Lehi (also known as the Stern gang) assassinates Count Folke Bernadotte, who was appointed by the United Nations to mediate between the Arab nations and Israel.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar